

Conflict Of Interest Policy 13

CONFLICT OF INTEREST POLICY

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Policy Number: ETH-001
Policy Title: Conflict of Interest Policy
Effective Date: January 1, 2026
Review Date: January 1, 2027
Owner: Ethics and Compliance Department

PURPOSE

This policy establishes guidelines for identifying, disclosing, and managing conflicts of interest at GlobalTech Corporation to ensure ethical business practices, maintain integrity, and protect the company's reputation.

SCOPE

This policy applies to all employees, officers, directors, contractors, and consultants of GlobalTech Corporation.

DEFINITIONS

Conflict of Interest

A conflict of interest occurs when an individual's personal interests could compromise their judgment, objectivity, or ability to act in the best interests of GlobalTech Corporation.

Types of Conflicts

- Financial conflicts: Personal financial gain from company decisions
- Employment conflicts: Outside employment affecting company duties
- Family conflicts: Family members involved with company business
- Gift conflicts: Receiving inappropriate gifts or entertainment
- Competitive conflicts: Involvement with competitors or suppliers

IDENTIFYING CONFLICTS

Financial Interests

- Ownership or investment in competitors, suppliers, or customers
- Consulting arrangements with business partners
- Intellectual property rights that could conflict with company interests
- Debt or financial relationships with business partners

Employment Outside GlobalTech

- Employment with competitors, suppliers, or customers
- Board positions at other organizations
- Consulting or advisory roles
- Self-employment that could compete with company interests

Family Relationships

- Family members employed by competitors, suppliers, or customers
- Family members in positions that could influence company business
- Family ownership of businesses that interact with GlobalTech
- Personal relationships that could affect business judgment

Gifts and Entertainment

- Receiving gifts from vendors, suppliers, or partners
- Excessive entertainment from business associates
- Personal benefits from business relationships
- Favors or preferential treatment

DISCLOSURE REQUIREMENTS

Mandatory Disclosure

Employees must disclose potential conflicts when:

- Joining the company (during onboarding)
- A new conflict arises during employment
- Changes in personal or family circumstances
- Before entering into new business relationships
- Annually through the disclosure process

Disclosure Process

1. Complete Conflict of Interest Disclosure Form
2. Submit to Ethics and Compliance Department
3. Provide detailed information about the potential conflict
4. Cooperate with review and assessment process
5. Receive written determination of appropriate action

Disclosure Content

- Nature of the potential conflict
- Parties involved and their relationship to the company
- Financial interests, if applicable
- Duration and extent of the conflict
- Proposed management or resolution approach

MANAGING CONFLICTS

Review Process

- Ethics and Compliance reviews all disclosures
- Assessment of actual or perceived conflict
- Determination of appropriate management approach
- Documentation of review and decision

- Regular monitoring of managed conflicts

Resolution Strategies

- Recusal from decision-making processes
- Divestment of conflicting interests
- Termination of conflicting relationships
- Modification of job responsibilities
- Enhanced monitoring and oversight

Recusal

- Employees must recuse themselves from decisions involving conflicts
- Document recusal in appropriate systems
- Do not participate in discussions or votes
- Do not influence others' decisions
- Maintain confidentiality of recused matters

PROHIBITED ACTIVITIES

Strictly Prohibited

- Using company position for personal gain
- Diverting business opportunities to personal interests
- Accepting bribes or kickbacks
- Misusing company resources or information
- Competing with the company while employed

Outside Employment

- Employment with competitors without approval
- Self-employment that conflicts with company interests
- Consulting for competitors or suppliers without disclosure
- Board positions that create conflicts without approval

Gifts and Entertainment

- Accepting cash or cash equivalents
- Excessive gifts or entertainment from business partners
- Gifts that create obligation or expectation
- Entertainment that could influence business decisions

CONFIDENTIALITY AND INTEGRITY

Protecting Company Information

- Never use confidential information for personal gain
- Do not share confidential information with outside interests
- Maintain confidentiality even after employment ends
- Follow all data security and privacy policies

Competitive Intelligence

- Gather competitive information through legal and ethical means only
- Do not use confidential information from previous employers

- Respect intellectual property rights
- Follow industry standards for competitive intelligence

Business Integrity

- Make decisions based on best interests of the company
- Avoid even the appearance of impropriety
- Maintain independence and objectivity
- Follow ethical business practices

REPORTING AND WHISTLEBLOWER PROTECTION

Reporting Obligations

- Report known conflicts of interest immediately
- Report suspected violations of this policy
- Cooperate with investigations
- Provide accurate and complete information

Whistleblower Protection

- No retaliation for good faith reporting
- Confidential reporting available
- Anonymous reporting options available
- Protection against discrimination, harassment, or termination

Reporting Channels

- Direct manager (if appropriate)
- Ethics and Compliance Department
- Ethics Hotline: 555-0999 (24/7, anonymous)
- Legal Department
- Human Resources

COMPLIANCE AND ENFORCEMENT

Policy Compliance

- All employees must comply with this policy
- Failure to disclose conflicts is a violation
- Violations may result in disciplinary action
- Serious violations may result in termination

Investigations

- All reports investigated promptly and thoroughly
- Fair process for all parties involved
- Confidentiality maintained to extent possible
- Appropriate remedial actions taken

Disciplinary Action

- Disciplinary action based on severity of violation
- Possible actions: warning, reassignment, termination
- Legal action may be taken

- for violations causing harm
- Cooperation with law enforcement when appropriate

TRAINING AND EDUCATION

Mandatory Training

- Conflict of interest training for all new employees
- Annual refresher training for all employees
- Specialized training for managers and executives
- Training on ethical decision-making

Resources

- Ethics and Compliance Department: ethics@globaltech.com
- Ethics Hotline: 555-0999 (24/7, anonymous)
- Legal Department: legal@globaltech.com
- HR Department: hr@globaltech.com
- Ethics resources on company intranet

LEADERSHIP RESPONSIBILITIES

Managers and Executives

- Model ethical behavior and conflict disclosure
- Encourage team members to disclose potential conflicts
- Support recusal and conflict management processes
- Do not pressure employees to compromise ethics
- Report conflicts involving their direct reports

Board of Directors

- Annual conflict of interest disclosures required
- Recusal from decisions involving personal interests
- Independent review of board conflicts
- Public disclosure of material conflicts

CONTACT INFORMATION

Ethics and Compliance Department

Phone: 555-0190

Email: ethics@globaltech.com

Location: 6th Floor, Ethics and Compliance Department

Ethics Hotline: 555-0999 (24/7, anonymous)

For questions about this policy, contact the Ethics and Compliance Department.

POLICY ACKNOWLEDGMENT

I acknowledge that I have read and understand the Conflict of Interest Policy. I agree to disclose any potential conflicts of interest and comply with all provisions of this policy. I understand that violations may result in disciplinary action.

Employee Signature: _____

Employee Name: _____

Employee ID: _____

Date: _____